MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI Sustainability and Climate Symbols & Definitions

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Introduction

MSCI Sustainability and Climate (MSCI S&C)[1] develops and maintains S&C Ratings and S&C Data Products. To promote transparency, MSCI S&C provides below a description of S&C Ratings methodologies and certain S&C Data Products methodologies.

S&C Ratings

MSCI ESG Ratings

MSCI ESG Ratings provide an opinion of companies' management of financially relevant sustainability risks and opportunities. MSCI S&C defines financially relevant sustainability risks and opportunities as environmental, social, or governance (ESG)-related issues that may result in financial losses or benefits to the company. MSCI ESG Ratings are industry-relative measures and are determined at the company level. Each rating takes into consideration the company's exposure to potentially material ESG risks, the quality of companies' management systems and governance structures to mitigate such risks, and where applicable, positioning to meet market demand for the provision of products and services that have a positive environmental or social contribution.

MSCI ESG Rating Scale

AAA	Companies rated AAA have the highest ESG Rating assigned by MSCI S&C. Compared to global industry peers, they have the strongest aggregate management measures of their ESG risks and are often involved in products or services that provide environmental or social solutions. Companies rated AAA must meet a minimum corporate governance threshold and cannot be directly involved in any ongoing Very Severe controversies.
AA	Companies rated AA have very strong management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global industry peers.
A	Companies rated A have strong management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global industry peers.
BBB	Companies rated BBB have moderate management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global industry peers.
BB	Companies rated BB have weak management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global industry peers.
B	Companies rated B have poor management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global industry peers.

[1] MSCI Sustainability and Climate products and services are provided by MSCI S&C and certain related entities, and are designed to provide in-depth research, ratings and analysis of environmental, social and governance-related business practices to entities worldwide.

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CCC	Companies rated CCC have the lowest ESG Rating assigned by MSCI S&C. Compared to global industry peers, they have very poor management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities. CCC-rated companies may also be presently or recently involved in significant controversies.

MSCI ESG Leader, Average, and ESG Laggard Categorizations[2]

ESG Leader	Companies rated AAA or AA.
Average	Companies rated A, BBB or BB.
ESG Laggard	Companies rated B or CCC.

MSCI ESG Rating Actions[3]

Upgrade	The MSCI ESG Rating has increased in the scale since the previous rating action.
Maintain	The MSCI ESG Rating has not changed in the scale since the previous rating action.
Downgrade	The MSCI ESG Rating has decreased in the scale since the previous rating action.
Re-initiate	An ESG Rating has been assigned to a previously rated company that had a prior ESG Rating based on a different industry peer set.
Initiate	An MSCI ESG Rating has been assigned to a previously unrated company.

MSCI Provisional ESG Rating: "(p)" prefix

MSCI Provisional ESG Ratings with the "(p)" prefix are point-in-time, solicited ESG Ratings that are based on public information and non-public information provided by the rated company to MSCI S&C. MSCI Provisional ESG Ratings are intended to provide privately held and unrated companies with a point-in-time opinion of their ESG Rating if they were in the MSCI ESG Rating coverage universe. In cases where the company is added to the MSCI ESG Rating coverage universe, the subsequent MSCI ESG Rating may differ from its previously assigned MSCI Provisional ESG Rating.

[2] ESG Leader, Average, and Laggard categories apply to ESG Ratings, Government ESG Ratings, and Fund ESG Ratings.

[3] Rating actions apply to ESG Ratings and Government ESG Ratings

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Governance Metrics

Governance Metrics scores provide a quantitative assessment of corporate governance risk for companies that are equity and fixed income issuers, reflecting the potential for a company's governance structures and practices to inadequately protect the interests of holders of both equity and bonds. This assessment measures risk on a forward-looking long-term time horizon of five or more years. MSCI S&C produces an overall Corporate Governance Theme Score on an absolute 0-10 scale, with 0 indicating the highest governance risk and 10 indicating the lowest governance risk. A Key Issue Score on the same scale is also produced for each of the Accounting, Board, Ownership & Control and Pay Key Issues. These Scores are inputs into MSCI ESG Ratings, as well as being independently reported.

MSCI Indicative ESG Scores

Indicative ESG Scores are a quantitative assessment of companies' management of financially relevant ESG risks and opportunities based on the MSCI ESG Ratings of similar companies. Indicative ESG Scores are calculated as industry-relative scores and are determined at the legal-entity level. Indicative ESG Scores take into consideration the company's exposure to potentially material ESG risks and the company's expected level of risk management based on the level of risk management observed in similar companies with an MSCI ESG Rating. Indicative ESG Scores reflect the general characteristics of similar companies, without accounting for company-specific factors. They are based on three key inputs: sector, location and size (as measured by revenue).

The Indicative ESG Score model provides a single numeric score (0–10) as its main output where 10 indicates the strongest inferred management of financially relevant ESG risks and opportunities relative to industry peers, and 0 indicates the weakest, based on the general characteristics of similar companies by sector, location, and size, without accounting for company-specific factors.

MSCI ESG Government Ratings

MSCI ESG Government Ratings provide an opinion of sovereign and sub-sovereign entities' exposure to and management of ESG risks. MSCI S&C defines ESG risks to sovereign and sub-sovereign entities as environmental, social, or governance-related issues that could impact the long-term sustainability of economies. MSCI ESG Government Ratings are determined for countries, local authorities and supranational administrative bodies and are relative to a global peer set. Each rating takes into consideration measures of environmental risk and management, knowledge and social capital and the strength of financial, judicial and political systems.

MSCI ESG Government Rating Scale

AAA	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities rated AAA have the highest ESG Rating assigned by MSCI S&C. Compared to a global peer set, they have the strongest aggregate management measures relative to their ESG risks.

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AA	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities rated AA have very strong management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks, in comparison to a global peer set.
A	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities rated A have strong management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks, in comparison to a global peer set.
BBB	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities rated BBB have moderate management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks, in comparison to a global peer set.
BB	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities rated BB have weak management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks, in comparison to a global peer set.
B	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities rated B have poor management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks, in comparison to a global peer set.
CCC	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities rated CCC have the lowest ESG Rating assigned by MSCI S&C. Compared to a global peer set, they have very poor management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks.

MSCI ESG Government Rating Buffer Zone

Upper	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities with ESG scores that are in the upper buffer zone of the current ESG Government Rating. Buffer zones are centered at each MSCI Government ESG Rating band boundary to maintain greater stability in ESG Ratings.
Not in Buffer Zone	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities with ESG scores that are not in a buffer zone. Buffer zones are centered at each MSCI ESG Government Rating band boundary to maintain greater stability in MSCI Government ESG Ratings.
Lower	Sovereign and sub-sovereign entities with ESG scores that are in the lower buffer zone of the current MSCI Government ESG Rating. Buffer zones are centered at each MSCI Government ESG Rating band boundary to maintain greater stability in MSCI Government ESG Ratings.

MSCI Fund ESG Ratings

MSCI Fund ESG Ratings are a quantitative assessment of a fund's holdings' management of financially relevant ESG risks and opportunities. Fund ESG Ratings are based on the weighted average of holdings' ESG Ratings and ESG Government Ratings. Fund ESG Ratings do not consider the investment strategy, management, or performance of the fund.

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MSCI Fund ESG Rating Scale

AAA	Funds rated AAA have the highest ESG Rating assigned by MSCI S&C. AAA-rated funds have holdings that are rated AAA, on average. Holdings rated AAA have the strongest management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global peers. The fund may include holdings that are rated lower than AAA.
AA	AA-rated funds have investments that are rated AA, on average. Holdings rated AA have very strong management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global peers. The fund may include holdings that are rated higher or lower than AA.
A	A-rated funds have holdings that are rated A, on average. Holdings rated A have strong management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global peers. The fund may include holdings that are rated higher or lower than A.
BBB	BBB-rated funds have holdings that are rated BBB, on average. Holdings rated BBB have moderate management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global peers. The fund may include holdings that are rated higher or lower than BBB.
BB	BB-rated funds have holdings that are rated BB, on average. Holdings rated BB have weak management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global peers. The fund may include holdings that are rated higher or lower than BB.
B	B-rated funds have holdings that are rated B, on average. Holdings rated B have poor management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global peers. The fund may include holdings that are rated higher or lower than B.
CCC	Funds rated CCC have the lowest ESG Rating assigned by MSCI S&C. CCC-rated funds have holdings that are rated CCC, on average. Holdings rated CCC have very poor management measures relative to their aggregate ESG risks and opportunities, in comparison to global peers. The fund may include holdings that are rated higher than CCC.

MSCI Controversies

MSCI Controversy Scores and Flags provide an opinion of a company's involvement in controversies and incidents involving allegations of adverse impact on society or the environment. Controversy severity is assessed based on the nature and scale of the alleged adverse impact on society or the environment.

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MSCI Controversy Scores and the corresponding color-coded Flag are determined for individual controversy cases and consequently applied at the company level. Each controversy case assessment is based on a qualitative evaluation of the case severity based on the nature and scale of alleged impact from Minor to Very Severe, the company's direct or indirect role in the case, and the case status.

MSCI Controversies Flag Scale

Red Flag	Companies with a Red Flag are directly involved in one or more Very Severe ongoing controversies.
Orange Flag	Companies with an Orange Flag may have either settled some stakeholders' concerns related to their direct involvement in a Very Severe controversy, continue to be indirectly implicated in a Very Severe controversy related to its business partners, or are directly involved in one or more Severe cases.
Yellow Flag	Companies with a Yellow Flag may have either settled most or all of stakeholders' concerns related to their involvement in Severe or Very Severe controversy cases or continue to be directly involved in one or more cases of Moderate severity.
Green Flag	Companies with a Green Flag may either be involved in one or more controversies of lesser severity or not involved in any controversies.

MSCI Global Norms

MSCI Global Norms provides an opinion of companies' alignment on each of the following global norms: the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises, the United Nations Global Compact Principles (UNGC), the International Labour Organization's (ILO) fundamental conventions and the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights (UNGP). Companies are assigned a Pass, Fail or Watch List designation based on their involvement in Controversies that potentially conflict with the principles defined by each global norm.

MSCI Global Norms Scale

Pass	Companies with a Pass designation are not involved in controversies that are severe enough to warrant a Fail or Watch List designation.
Watch List	Companies with a Watch List designation are involved in one or more controversies that potentially conflict with the principles of a given convention, but at a lesser severity than companies on the Fail list.
Fail	Companies with a Fail designation are directly involved in one or more Ongoing Very Severe controversies that potentially conflict with the principles defined for a given convention.

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MSCI SDG Alignment

MSCI SDG Alignment Scores and Assessments are a quantitative assessment of companies' alignment with the 17 United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDG). SDG Alignment Scores and their corresponding Alignment Assessments are determined at the company level for each of the 17 UN SDGs. Each SDG Alignment Assessment is based on the company's product portfolio and operating practices (including policies, initiatives, and performance metrics where available), which are evaluated on the balance of positive and negative attributes related to each SDG.

MSCI SDG Alignment Assessment Scale

Strongly Aligned	Companies that are Strongly Aligned on an SDG offer products and services that facilitate implementation of the goal and conduct their business in line with the intent of the SDG.
Aligned	Companies that are Aligned on an SDG offer products and services that facilitate implementation of the goal and/or conduct their business in line with the intent of the SDG. Misalignment on one characteristic may be offset by strong alignment on another.
Neutral	Companies that are Neutral on an SDG have minimal or no impact on the advancement of the goal through their products or practices. Misalignment on one characteristic may be offset by alignment on another.
Misaligned	Companies that are Misaligned on an SDG offer products and services that are misaligned with the intent of the SDG or whose operating practices do not show alignment with the goal. Misalignment on one characteristic may be offset by alignment on another.
Strongly Misaligned	Companies that are Strongly Misaligned on an SDG either generate most of their revenue from products and services that are misaligned with the goal or are involved in practices or events that suggest severe adverse impact on society, environment, or economies.

MSCI Low Carbon Transition Risk Assessment

MSCI Low Carbon Transition (LCT) Scores and Categories assess companies' exposure to risks and opportunities related to the low carbon transition based on the carbon-intensive nature of their business lines. Climate transition risks and opportunities arise from changes in demand for products and services due to policy or regulatory action to address climate change. LCT Scores and their corresponding LCT Categories are determined at the company level. LCT Scores (0-10) are industry-relative measures and are based on both the primary risks (e.g., changes in market dynamics or regulations) and secondary risks (risks affecting the economy as a whole) a company faces from the transition. LCT Categories are

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based on LCT Scores and highlight the predominant risks and opportunities a company is most likely to face in the transition

MSCI Low Carbon Transition Score and Category Scale

0.00 – 2.09	Asset Stranding	Potential to experience "stranding" of physical / natural assets due to regulatory, market, or technological forces arising from low carbon transition.
2.09 – 5.65	Product Transition	Reduced demand for carbon-intensive products and services. Leaders and laggards are defined by the ability to shift product portfolio to low-carbon products.
	Operational Transition	Increased operational and/or capital cost due to carbon taxes and/or investment in carbon emission mitigation measures leading to lower profitability of the companies.
5.65 – 7.14	Neutral	Limited exposure to low carbon transition carbon risk. Though companies in this category could have exposure to physical risk and/or indirect exposure to low carbon transition risk via lending, investment etc.
7.14 – 10	Solutions	Potential to benefit through the growth of low-carbon products and services.

Note: Appearance of overlap in the score ranges is due to rounding.

Fund Low Carbon Transition Scores

The Fund Low Carbon Transition Score is designed to assess the exposure of a fund's aggregate holdings to risks and opportunities related to the low carbon transition based on the carbon-intensive nature of the business lines of the underlying holdings of the fund. It is expressed as an absolute 0-10 score, with 10 indicating the highest level of alignment to Low Carbon Transition. The Fund Low Carbon Transition Score is based on issuer data from MSCI S&C's Low Carbon Transition Risk Assessment.

MSCI Implied Temperature Rise

MSCI Implied Temperature Rise (ITR) provides a forward-looking quantitative assessment of companies' alignment with global temperature goals, expressed in degrees Celsius. Implied Temperature Rise is calculated at the company level. The Implied Temperature Rise of a company is calculated based on its

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projected emissions considering disclosed emissions reduction targets and the over- or undershoot in emissions relative to its share of the global carbon budget.

MSCI Implied Temperature Rise Bands

1.5°C Aligned	Companies that are 1.5°C Aligned are aligned with the Paris Agreement's maximal objective of limiting the global mean temperature rise to 1.5°C compared with preindustrial levels.
2°C Aligned	Companies that are 2°C Aligned meet the Paris Agreement's minimum objective of limiting the global mean temperature rise to 2°C compared with preindustrial levels.
Misaligned	Companies that are Misaligned are not aligned with the Paris Agreement goals. Their implied temperature rise falls between 2°C and 3.2°C.
Strongly Misaligned	Companies that are Strongly Misaligned have an implied temperature rise that is greater than 3.2°C, which exceeds even the business-as-usual climate projection.

Fund Implied Temperature Rise

The Fund Implied Temperature Rise Band is designed to assess the aggregate alignment of the fund's holdings with the Paris Agreement temperature goals. It is assessed on a four-category scale; 1.5°C Aligned, 2°C Aligned, Misaligned, and Strongly Misaligned. The Fund Implied Temperature Rise Band is derived from MSCI S&C's issuer-level MSCI Implied Temperature Rise.

Fund Implied Temperature Rise Bands

1.5°C Aligned	The fund aligns with the Paris Agreement's maximal objective of limiting the global mean temperature rise to 1.5°C compared with preindustrial levels. It is a transition leader, significantly contributing to mitigating catastrophic climate change.
2°C Aligned	The fund aligns with the Paris Agreement's minimum objective of limiting the global mean temperature rise to 2°C compared with preindustrial levels. It is engaged in the low-carbon transition.
Misaligned	The fund does not align with the Paris Agreement goals. Its pace of decarbonization is too slow to mitigate catastrophic climate change. The implied temperature rise falls between 2°C and 3.2°C.
Strongly Misaligned	The fund is misaligned even by business-as-usual standards. Funds that are Strongly Misaligned have an implied temperature rise that is greater than 3.2°C.

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MSCI Country Scope 1 Emissions Implied Temperature Rise

MSCI Country Scope 1 Emissions Implied Temperature Rise (ITR) provides a forward-looking quantitative assessment of countries' alignment with global temperature goals, expressed in degrees Celsius. Implied Temperature Rise is calculated at the country level. The Implied Temperature Rise of a country is calculated based on its projected Scope 1 emissions considering disclosed emissions reduction targets and the over- or undershoot in emissions relative to its carbon budget, taking into account the country's basic needs and stage of development and a global cost-effectiveness criterion.

MSCI Country Scope 1 Emissions Implied Temperature Rise Bands

1.5°C Aligned	Countries that are 1.5°C Aligned are aligned with the Paris Agreement's maximal objective of limiting the global mean temperature rise to 1.5°C compared with preindustrial levels. They either significantly contribute to mitigating catastrophic climate change, benefit from relatively large needs-based effort-sharing carbon budgets because they are in earlier stages of economic development, or both.
2°C Aligned	Countries that are 2°C Aligned meet the Paris Agreement's minimum objective of limiting the global mean temperature rise to 2°C compared with preindustrial levels. They support a low-carbon transition, benefit from relatively large needs-based effort-sharing carbon budgets because they are in earlier stages of economic development, or both.
Misaligned	Countries that are Misaligned are not aligned with the Paris Agreement goals. Their pace of decarbonization is too slow to mitigate catastrophic climate change. Their implied temperature rise falls between 2°C and 3.2°C, even after any positive adjustments made to their carbon budgets if they are in earlier stages of economic development.
Strongly Misaligned	Countries that are Strongly Misaligned have an implied temperature rise that is greater than 3.2°C, which exceeds even the business-as-usual climate projection, even after any positive adjustments made to their carbon budgets if they are in earlier stages of economic development. Their contribution to catastrophic climate change is higher than that of most countries.

MSCI Carbon Project Ratings

MSCI Carbon Project Ratings are composite ratings that provide an opinion on the integrity and risks of carbon credit projects across multiple criteria, including their impacts on the climate, environment and society. A project with a high rating has a greater likelihood of having a positive emissions impact and a reduced risk of overestimating its emissions impact. It is also more likely that such an emissions impact

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will have been implemented in a way that supports positive social and/or environmental outcomes and upholds legal and ethical standards.[4]

MSCI S&C also offers solicited Carbon Project Ratings, which are intended to provide unrated projects with a Carbon Project Rating. Solicited Ratings follow the same methodology as a typical Carbon Project Rating.

MSCI Carbon Project Ratings scale

AAA	Projects rated AAA have the highest Carbon Project Rating assigned by MSCI S&C. There is a very high likelihood that these projects will deliver and support **both** at least a 1 tonne CO_2e emissions impact per credit and a range of positive social and/or environmental outcomes while upholding legal and ethical standards.
AA	There is a high likelihood that projects rated AA will deliver and support both a 1 tonne CO_2e emissions impact per credit and a range of positive social and/or environmental outcomes while upholding legal and ethical standards.
A	There is a moderate to high likelihood that projects rated A will deliver and support both a 1 tonne CO_2e emissions impact per credit and a range of positive social and/or environmental outcomes while upholding legal and ethical standards.
BBB	There is a moderate likelihood that projects rated BBB will deliver and support both a majority of a 1 tonne CO_2e emissions impact per credit and a range of material positive social and/or environmental outcomes while upholding legal and ethical standards.
BB	There is a low likelihood that projects rated BB will deliver and support either a majority of a 1 tonne CO_2e emissions impact per credit or material positive social and/or environmental outcomes while upholding legal and ethical standards.
B	There is a very low likelihood that projects rated B will deliver and support either a 1 tonne CO_2e emissions impact per credit or material positive social and/or environmental outcomes while upholding legal and ethical standards.
CCC	Projects rated CCC have the lowest Carbon Project Rating assigned by MSCI S&C. These projects have significant risks regarding either delivering a 1 tonne CO_2e emissions impact per credit or supporting material positive social and/or environmental outcomes while upholding legal and ethical standards.

[4] More information regarding the MSCI Carbon Project Ratings assessment process and an explanation of the criteria assessed are detailed in the overall MSCI Carbon Project Ratings methodology document, "MSCI Carbon Project Ratings and Assessments Methodology."

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Carbon Markets – Country Scores

MSCI Carbon Markets – Country Scores provide an assessment of the opportunities and risks for carbon credit projects generated by the country policy environment for the sovereign entity in question, covering regulatory, political, socioeconomic and environmental factors. For each country, risks and opportunities are assessed at the national level. The outputs are the Country Carbon Market Score and Country Article 6 Score. To enable global comparison, these values are expressed as relative to a global peer set.

Country Carbon Market Scores are expressed as a numeric score (1.00–5.00), where 1.00 indicates the lowest suitability for developing and operating carbon projects, and 5.00 indicates the highest suitability for developing and operating carbon projects.

Country Carbon Market Scores scale

1.00-1.49	Very low
1.50-2.49	Low
2.50-3.49	Moderate
3.50-4.49	High
4.50-5.00	Very high

Country Article 6 Scores are expressed as a numeric score (1.00–5.00), where 1.00 indicates the highest risk for trading credits from projects internationally under Article 6 of the Paris Agreement, and 5.00 indicates the lowest risk for trading credits from projects internationally under Article 6. Article 6 establishes the international framework for how countries may cooperate to achieve their climate commitments. It enables countries to use emissions reductions/removals generated outside their borders to meet part of their Nationally Determined Contributions, provided this use is transparent and does not result in double counting, and it also allows private entities in different countries to participate in this process.

Country Article 6 Scores scale

1.00-1.49	Very low
1.50-2.49	Low
2.50-3.49	Moderate
3.50-4.49	High
4.50-5.00	Very high

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MSCI Energy Transition Framework

The MSCI Energy Transition Framework produces a forward-looking composite score that assesses the level of economic risk a company may face from the energy transition in the next five to seven years and how well positioned it is to avoid associated costs and generate revenue opportunities. The objective of the overall Energy Transition Score is to indicate how well a company is positioned — its transition readiness — relative to its level of risk — its transition pressure. The model's outputs are expressed on a 0-10 absolute scale, with 0 indicating low transition readiness relative to the company's level of transition pressure and 10 indicating high transition readiness relative to the company's level of transition pressure.

Fund Energy Transition Scores

The Fund Energy Transition Score is designed to assess the readiness of a fund's aggregate holdings to manage the risks and capitalize on the opportunities of the energy transition. It is expressed as an absolute 0-10 score, with 10 indicating the highest level of transition readiness relative to transition pressure. The Fund Energy Transition Score is derived from MSCI Energy Transition Scores of company issuers.

MSCI Austrian Ecolabel Alignment Metrics

MSCI Austrian Ecolabel Alignment Metrics assess the overall performance of a company against the selection requirements of the Austrian Ecolabel (Umweltzeichen, UZ 49) for sustainable financial products. The Score is an aggregate assessment of environmental, social and governance (ESG) factors, combining the MSCI ESG Rating, the MSCI SDG Net Alignment Score and the MSCI SFDR Principal Adverse Impact (PAI) Score (which is calculated from the MSCI SFDR Adverse Impact Metrics). The methodology applies a double materiality lens: the MSCI ESG Rating component captures financially material ESG risks and opportunities facing the company (50%), while the MSCI SDG Net Alignment Score and MSCI SFDR PAI Score components capture the impacts of the company's activities on society and the environment (50%). The model's outputs are expressed on a 0-10 scale, with 0 indicating low relative performance against the UZ 49 selection requirements relative to the coverage universe and 10 indicating high relative performance against the UZ 49 selection requirements relative to the coverage universe.

S&C Data Products

MSCI Labeled Bond and Loan Assessment

MSCI Labeled Bond and Loan Assessments are instrument-level opinions of the environmental and social characteristics of issued bonds, syndicated loans, and revolving credit facilities. The MSCI Labeled Bond and Loan Assessment methodology defines the criteria that are used to determine an instrument's eligibility to be labeled as green (for proceeds that have a positive environmental impact), social (for

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proceeds that have a positive social impact), or sustainability (for proceeds that have a combination of green and social impacts). The criteria are defined across four attributes: use of proceeds, process for project evaluation and selection, process for management of proceeds and ongoing reporting.

Pass	The instrument meets the eligibility criteria to be labeled as green, social, or sustainability.
Fail	The instrument does not meet the eligibility criteria to be labeled as green, social, or sustainability.

Business Involvement Screening Research

Business Involvement Screening Research provides company-level data on the extent of involvement in products, services or events that may cause, contribute to, or be associated with adverse social or environmental impacts. Business Involvement Screening Research also provides data on companies' involvement in products and services that may conflict with certain investors' values. The data is based on disclosed revenue and estimates of revenue that are based on extrapolations from related company disclosures.

Sustainable Impact Metrics

Sustainable Impact Metrics provides company-level data on the extent of involvement in products or services that contribute positively to environmental or social outcomes. The data is based on disclosed revenue and estimates of revenue that are determined by extrapolations from company disclosures.

MSCI SFDR Adverse Impact Metrics

MSCI SFDR Adverse Impact Metrics provides entity-level and portfolio-level data to support financial market participants' objectives related to the EU Sustainable Finance Disclosure Regulation (SFDR) and the Market in Financial Instruments Directive (MiFID II). The SFDR defines a set of indicators and metrics — the Principal Adverse Impact (PAI) indicators — that guide reporting on sustainability risks arising from investments in companies, sovereigns and supranational bodies. PAIs are calculated based on a combination of company disclosures, third-party data sources, and assessments from MSCI S&C, including MSCI Controversies and carbon emissions estimates. PAIs are aggregated at the fund and portfolio levels based on the underlying holdings.

MSCI EU Taxonomy

The MSCI EU Taxonomy dataset provides company-level data to support financial market participants' objectives related to the EU Taxonomy regulation, which includes a classification of environmentally sustainable economic activities. The dataset includes company-level reported data on key performance indicators defined by the EU Taxonomy regulation, and estimates of revenue derived from business

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activities that are potentially aligned with the EU Taxonomy, considering the Do No Significant Harm and Minimum Safeguard criteria. The data is based on company disclosures and assessments from MSCI S&C, including MSCI Controversies, carbon emissions estimates, and revenue estimates that are based on extrapolations from company disclosures.

Workforce Gender Diversity data

The MSCI Workforce Gender Diversity data set provides data and an aggregated assessment of companies' workplace gender diversity. Currently, this data set is available for the top 700 Japanese companies by market capitalization.

Climate Value-at-Risk

Climate Value-at-Risk (Climate VaR) provides a forward-looking and return-based valuation assessment to measure climate-related risks and opportunities. Climate VaR is a quantitative assessment calculated at the company and security level. The aggregated company Climate VaR is calculated as a percentage of market value (from -100% to +100%) for multiple climate scenarios and includes the valuation impacts arising from technology opportunities, policy risks and physical risks.

Greenhouse Gas Emissions data

The Greenhouse Gas Protocol (GHGP) has set the global standard for emissions accounting for companies. It defines three emissions scopes which form a complete picture of all emissions generated directly or indirectly by a company. MSCI S&C collects reported emissions and uses proprietary estimation methodologies. The estimation methodologies follow the GHGP's accounting principles as closely as possible.

MSCI Fossil Fuels and Power Generation Metrics

The MSCI S&C Fossil Fuels and Power Generation Metrics methodology identifies companies involved in fossil fuel-related assets and activities such as fossil fuel reserves, resource extraction, fossil fuel processing, power generation and generation capacity, related revenues and capital investments. The metrics are based on disclosed data and estimates derived from company disclosures and eligible third-party sources (e.g., government sites, NGOs).

Climate Targets and Commitments data

Climate Targets and Commitments data provides a standardized view on company's decarbonization plans. The quantitative assessment normalizes companies' climate targets and calculates comprehensiveness, ambition and feasibility across a company's decarbonization plans.

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MSCI Paris Aligned Investing Initiative (PAII) Net Zero Investment Framework 2.0 (NZIF 2.0) indicative mapping

MSCI Paris Aligned Investing Initiative (PAII) Net Zero Investment Framework (NZIF) indicative mapping is a metric that maps companies to alignment categories as determined in the PAII NZIF 2.0 guidance, from Not Aligning to Achieving Net Zero. The PAII NZIF 2.0 guidance is a categorical alignment assessment based on a set of criteria (e.g., short- and medium-term science-based targets), released by the PAII.

NZIF 2.0 Alignment categories

Achieving Net Zero	Companies that have previously met all alignment criteria and have an emissions performance at net-zero that can be expected to continue. They are considered to have achieved their low-carbon transition.
Aligned	Companies that have a net-zero goal; science-based targets; a decarbonization plan (except for lower impact companies); and current absolute intensity at least equal to a relevant net-zero pathway. They are considered to manage transition risk.
Aligning	Companies that have an emissions performance not equal to a contextually relevant net-zero pathway. However, they have a net-zero goal; science-based targets; and a decarbonization plan (except for lower impact companies). They are considered ready to transition.
Committed	Companies that have a net-zero goal. They are considered to have an alignment ambition but lack key transition steps (e.g., science-based targets).
Not Aligning	Companies that do not fall into any other alignment category.

Additional definitions

MSCI S&C Score

An MSCI S&C Score is a unit-less numeral within a predefined range that indicates a relative judgement within a ranking system of defined categories as part of an S&C Rating. A complete list of MSCI S&C Scores is given in the Appendix.

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Appendix: List of MSCI S&C Scores

MSCI ESG Ratings

Industry Adjusted Score.

Weighted Average Key Issue Score.

Environmental Pillar Score.

Social Pillar Score.

Governance Pillar Score.

Climate Change Theme Score.

Natural Capital Theme Score.

Pollution & Waste Theme Score.

Environmental Opportunities Theme Score.

Human Capital Theme Score.

Product Liability Theme Score.

Stakeholder Opposition Theme Score.

Social Opportunities Theme Score.

Corporate Governance Theme Score.

Corporate Behavior Theme Score.

Accounting Key Issue Score.

Board Key Issue Score.

Business Ethics Key Issue Score.

Ownership & Control Key Issue Score.

Pay Key Issue Score.

Tax Transparency Key Issue Score.

MSCI Provisional ESG Ratings

Industry Adjusted Score.

Weighted Average Key Issue Score.

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Environmental Pillar Score.

Social Pillar Score.

Governance Pillar Score.

Climate Change Theme Score.

Natural Capital Theme Score.

Pollution & Waste Theme Score.

Environmental Opportunities Theme Score.

Human Capital Theme Score.

Product Liability Theme Score.

Stakeholder Opposition Theme Score.

Social Opportunities Theme Score.

Corporate Governance Theme Score.

Corporate Behavior Theme Score.

Accounting Key Issue Score.

Board Key Issue Score.

Business Ethics Key Issue Score.

Ownership & Control Key Issue Score.

Pay Key Issue Score.

Tax Transparency Key Issue Score.

Governance Metrics

Corporate Governance Theme Score.

Accounting Key Issue Score.

Board Key Issue Score.

Ownership & Control Key Issue Score.

Pay Key Issue Score.

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MSCI Indicative ESG Scores

Indicative ESG Industry Adjusted Score.

Indicative Weighted Average Key Issue Score

MSCI ESG Government Ratings

ESG Government Score.

MSCI ESG Fund Ratings

Fund ESG Quality Score.

MSCI Controversies

Overall Company Score.

MSCI SDG Alignment

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 1.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 2.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 3.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 4.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 5.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 6.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 7.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 8.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 9.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 10.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 11.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 12.

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SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 13.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 14.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 15.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 16.

SDG Net Alignment Score for SDG 17.

MSCI Low Carbon Transition Risk Assessment

Low Carbon Transition Score.

Fund Low Carbon Transition Scores

Fund Low Carbon Transition Score.

MSCI Implied Temperature Rise

MSCI Implied Temperature Rise.

Fund Implied Temperature Rise

Fund Implied Temperature Rise.

MSCI Country Scope 1 Emissions Implied Temperature Rise

MSCI Country Scope 1 Emissions Implied Temperature Rise.

MSCI Carbon Project Ratings

Overall Integrity Score.

Article 6 Integrity Score.

Disclosure Score.

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Carbon Markets – Country Scores

Country Carbon Market Score.

Country Article 6 Score.

MSCI Energy Transition Framework

Energy Transition Score.

Fund Energy Transition Scores

Fund Energy Transition Score.

MSCI Austrian Ecolabel Alignment Metrics

MSCI Austrian Ecolabel Alignment Metric.

MSCI SDG Net Alignment Score.

MSCI SFDR Principal Adverse Impact (PAI) Score.

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